

Russell Dudek

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INTERVIEW THESIS BRIEF

Make strategy load-bearing.

Foundation Data Director of Operations - an evidence-grounded candidate point of view

Actual work: turn executive intent across Scout, tagging, analytics, marketing, data, partnerships, and internal AI into a revenue-governed operating portfolio that scales without unnecessary headcount or forcing the COO to reconstruct every dependency personally.

WHY THIS ROLE MATTERS NOW

Decision clarity is the product promise

Foundation Data's public proposition is not another dashboard. It is standardized data, comparable signals, trusted context, and earlier decisions. Internal execution must preserve the same clarity.

Scout raises the trust and adoption burden

Prioritized recommendations create more leverage than reporting, but also demand explicit data confidence, evaluation, feedback ownership, human authority, and a repeatable release path.

Scale is part of the market position

Public messaging emphasizes scaling insight without proportional headcount. The operating system must therefore expose hidden rework, exception load, custom delivery, and expert bottlenecks before growth adds coordination cost.

The company values direct ownership

Foundation Data describes a small, remote-first, pragmatic team where ownership is visible. The right answer is a lightweight execution mechanism, not a ceremonial PMO.

OPERATING CONTRADICTIONS

Tension	What the current pattern protects	What must become explicit
Speed vs. evidence	Fast learning and customer responsiveness	Definitions, evaluation, adoption owner, exception path, and decision threshold
Responsiveness vs. repeatability	Real customer nuance and market learning	Boundary between customer-specific work and a scalable product or service pattern
Lean scale vs. resilience	Low overhead and direct communication	Capacity load, dependency age, rework, support burden, and forecast confidence
Executive reach vs. internal clarity	OEM, NCM, customer, and partnership growth	Decision rights, one accountable owner, escalation logic, and portfolio trade-offs

CANDIDATE THESIS

Make strategy load-bearing. Every strategic initiative should reveal the customer decision it improves, the economics it carries, one accountable owner, required commitments, capacity and trust conditions, and the evidence that changes the next allocation decision. Without that common load path, growth remains trapped in coordination, rework, and personally carried context.

PUBLIC RESEARCH BASIS

Foundation Data homepage, About, Careers, Services, Scout, Dealers, Auto Groups, Vendors, Enterprise Partners, Privacy Policy, and Terms. The job description was supplied directly in chat; no public posting URL was verified.

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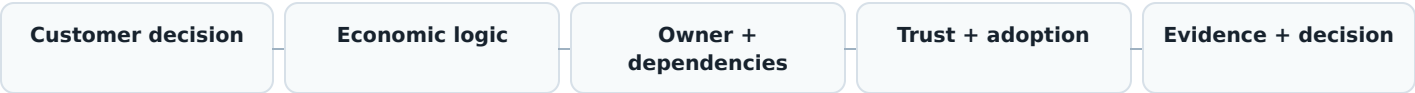
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OPERATING MODEL, EVIDENCE, AND INTERVIEW AGENDA

The Execution Load Test

A minimum viable system for turning a portfolio of priorities into explicit decisions without adding bureaucratic drag.



HOW THE MECHANISM WORKS

Initiative contract: define the decision, economics, owner, commitments, capacity, trust/adoption conditions, leading evidence, and next decision date. **Weekly Load Review:** spend 30-45 minutes only on changed assumptions, aged blockers, economic load, trust evidence, and explicit accelerate, sequence, repair, or stop choices. **Executive portfolio view:** make constrained capacity, platform leverage, dependency age, and forecast confidence visible. **Quarterly planning:** use the same grammar so roadmap and operating priorities can be compared directly.

PROOF MAP

Foundation Data need	Verified Russell evidence	Why it transfers
COO force multiplier and cross-functional execution	Vape-Jet operations across production, purchasing, quality, customer success, support, engineering issue flow, ERP, telemetry, and AI-assisted work	Direct experience making dependencies, priorities, dashboards, standard work, and accountability visible in a small technical company
Revenue-prioritized capacity and execution systems	Amazon launch and 24/7 operations supporting approximately five million second-day orders annually	High-cadence operating decisions connecting customer commitments, labor, throughput, quality, and escalation
Technical-team translation without being the engineer	Compunetics leadership across engineering, manufacturing, quality, customer delivery, and high-reliability programs	Long record translating technical work into controls, priorities, risk, and measurable delivery
AI-enabled efficiency with governance and adoption	DudeWorth workflow patterns using structured context, retrieval, human judgment, escalation, evaluation, and governance	AI is attached to real work, authority, adoption, evidence, and economic outcomes rather than theater

Transferability question: Russell is not a career dealership-analytics operator. The affirmative case is that this role's central risk is not vocabulary; it is failure to convert a fast-growing technical portfolio into clear economic priorities, owned dependencies, scalable workflows, and trusted execution. The first 30 days therefore include direct immersion in dealership economics, NCM context, tagging, measurement, and Scout workflows.

BALANCED SCORECARD

Business Revenue, retention, margin, repeatability	Operations Throughput, blocker age, forecast confidence	Trust Data quality, exceptions, evaluation	Adoption Use, usefulness, support load, learning speed
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EXECUTIVE QUESTIONS

COO leverage and execution - Which decisions should this role absorb within six months? - Where does executive intent lose force: prioritization, ownership, dependency closure, or follow-through?	Scout, economics, and capacity - What evidence defines a useful Scout recommendation? - Which data or tagging limitation most constrains the next phase?
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